



BSPML's

**JAIKRANTI COLLEGE OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND MANAGEMENT STUDIES ,
KATRAJ, Pune 411046**

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that

Student Name : _____

Class : Second Year BCA(Science) Sem IV

Seat No : _____

Subject Code : CC151_11

Subject Name : Study and Documentation of Forts and Historical Temples / Places of
Worships in Local Area

Academic Year: 2025-26

The project has been completed as a part of the curriculum prescribed by
Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune.

Mentor

HOD(BCA Dept)

Principal

Evaluation

Sr. No.	Program Title	Max Marks	Marks
1	Significance and relevance of the topic:	10	
2	Quality of historical data:	15	
3	Evaluation of submitted essay	15	
4	Presentation and discussion in the class/seminar:	10	
	Total	50	

Mentor

HOD(BCA Dept)

Principal

SAVITRIBAI PHULE PUNE UNIVERSITY, PUNE
CC-151-11-Study and Documentation of Forts and Historical Temples /
Places of Worships in Local Area

ACADEMIC YEAR
2025 – 2026

PROJECT REPORT ON

“LOHAGAD, PUNE, MAHARASHTRA

Submitted by
Shrinath Nareshsingh Thakur of Second Year BCA(Science)



❖ Introduction

Lohagad Fort is one of the most prominent and historically significant hill forts in Maharashtra. Situated near Lonavala in the **Sahyadri mountain range**, the fort stands at an elevation of approximately **1,033 meters above sea level**.

The name “Lohagad” means “**Iron Fort**”, which reflects its strong and nearly impenetrable structure. The fort has been under the control of various dynasties, including the **Satavahana Dynasty, Chalukyas, Rashtrakutas**, and later the **Maratha Empire**.

The fort gained major importance during the reign of **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj**, who used it as a strategic military base and treasury storage. Lohagad is also famous for its unique structure called **Vinchu Kata (Scorpion Tail)**, a long narrow ridge extending from the fort.

❖ Objectives of the Study

- To explore the historical background of Lohagad Fort
- To understand its role in the Maratha Empire
- To study its architectural design and defensive features
- To analyze its geographical importance
- To understand the cultural and social impact of the fort
- To promote awareness about heritage conservation
- To develop research and documentation skills



❖ **Significance of the Study**

The study of Lohagad Fort holds importance from multiple perspectives:

❖ **Historical Importance**

Lohagad Fort played a key role in the expansion of the Maratha Empire. It was used for storing treasure and securing trade routes.

❖ **Architectural Importance**

The fort demonstrates advanced military architecture with:

- Strong fortification walls
- Multiple gates
- Strategic watch points

❖ **Cultural Importance**

The fort is a symbol of regional pride and is deeply connected with the legacy of Shivaji Maharaj.

❖ **Educational Importance**

It helps students understand:

- Ancient warfare strategies
- Fort construction techniques
- Historical developments in Maharashtra

❖ **Environmental Importance**

The fort is surrounded by lush greenery, waterfalls, and biodiversity, especially during monsoon.

❖ Background / Context :-

1. Topography and Structure :-

Lohagad Fort is connected to **Visapur Fort**, which is located nearby.

Key structural features include:

- **Vinchu Kata (Scorpion Tail):** A long narrow ridge used for defense



- **Four Main Gates:**

- Ganesh Darwaza
- Narayan Darwaza
- Hanuman Darwaza
- Maha Darwaza

- **Water Tanks:** Used for storing water throughout the year
- **Temples and Bastions:** Indicating religious and military importance



❖ Historical Context :-

Lohagad Fort has witnessed the rule of several dynasties over centuries. However, it became highly significant under Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, who captured it in the 17th century.

The fort was later used by the Marathas to store valuable loot, including wealth obtained from Surat campaigns. Its strong structure made it ideal for safeguarding treasures.

❖ Climate and Environment :-

The region experiences a tropical climate:

- Monsoon (June–September): Heavy rainfall, lush greenery, waterfalls
- Winter (October–February): Cool and pleasant, best for trekking
- Summer (March–May): Warm but manageable due to elevation

The surrounding region is rich in flora and fauna, making it ecologically important.

❖ Social and Economic Context :-

Nearby villages depend on:

- Agriculture
- Tourism related to the fort

Local people work as:

- Guides
- Vendors
- Homestay providers

Tourism contributes significantly to the local economy.

❖ Architectural Features :-

Lohagad Fort is an excellent example of military engineering:

- Strong stone walls designed for defense
- Elevated position for surveillance
- Narrow pathways to restrict enemy movement
- Efficient water storage systems

The Vinchu Kata structure is particularly unique and strategically important.

❖ Social and Cultural Structure :-

The fort is associated with local traditions and festivals. People celebrate events like:

- Ganesh Chaturthi
- Diwali

It is also linked with stories and legends from the Maratha period, preserving cultural identity.

❖ Tourism and Current Condition :-

Lohagad Fort is a popular destination for:

- Trekking
- History enthusiasts
- Nature lovers

The fort is well-preserved but faces challenges such as:

- Littering
- Overcrowding during weekends

- **Environmental degradation**
-

❖ **Conservation and Preservation :-**

Efforts are needed to preserve Lohagad Fort:

- **Government and Archaeological Survey of India initiatives**
- **Awareness about responsible tourism**
- **Waste management systems**
- **Restoration of damaged structures**

Community participation is essential for long-term preservation.

❖ **Conclusion :-**

Lohagad Fort is a symbol of strength, strategic planning, and rich cultural heritage. It provides deep insights into the history of the Maratha Empire and the leadership of Shivaji Maharaj.

The study highlights the importance of preserving such monuments for future generations. With proper conservation and awareness, Lohagad Fort will continue to inspire and educate people.